

QUALITATIVE VS. QUANTITATIVE DATA

Data helps us understand learning and make better decisions. Some data comes from numbers (like scores and attendance). Other data comes from words and observations (like reflections and teacher notes). Using both gives a clearer picture.

Qualitative Data (Words & Stories)

What it is: Describes experiences, opinions, and observations.

Examples: Student reflections, interviews, classroom notes, open-ended survey responses.

Best for: Understanding why and how something is happening.

Quantitative Data (Numbers & Counts)

What it is: Measures amounts, scores, and frequencies.

Examples: quizzes/tests, attendance, reading level, missing assignments, time-on-task data. Best for: Tracking how much and how often something happens

Use Data Fairly and Responsibly

- Look for patterns, not labels.
- Consider context (language, access, health, responsibilities).
- Ask students what the numbers don't show.
- Use data to support growth, not to judge worth.

How to Use Data (3 Steps)

- Notice – What do you see? (patterns, changes, gaps)
- Ask – What might explain it? What information is missing?
- Act – What is one next step you can try?

Name: _____ Period: _____ Date: _____



GOAL SETTING WITH DATA

Use one number + one observation to build a goal you can actually reach.

Step 1: Pick 1 Quant + 1 Qual Data Point

Quantitative (number):

My current number is _____

(score/percent/level/assignments completed).

Qualitative (observation):

What I notice about my learning is

Step 3: Plan & Supports

*Strategy I Will Implement:**

(Example) Study for 15 minutes, four days a week.

*Support I Will Utilize:**

Teacher check-ins and family reminders.

*How I Will Measure Success:**

Increased quiz scores.

Step 2: Write a SMART Goal

Specific: _____

Measurable: _____

Achievable: _____

Relevant: _____

Time-Bound (By date): _____

Step 4: Check-In Reflection

- What worked?
- What was hard?
- What will I change next?

How Teachers & Families Can Support Students

- Help students choose one focus goal at a time.
- Do a quick weekly check-in: "What's your next step?"
- Give feedback that is specific: "Try ___" (not just "Do better").
- Celebrate progress, not perfection.
- Reduce barriers when possible (time, materials, access to help).